

A This error goes away after you download and install the latest patch for Splinter Cell Pandora Tomorrow. The latest patch (1.31) adds support for this new texture cap and removes the error message. You can download this patch at www.ubisoft.com.

Auto Connect?

Q I have Pentium 4 with 256 MB RAM running Windows XP Professional. I am facing a problem wherein my PC dials the Internet connection automatically, even when I open the command prompt or any software. Even when I restart my PC, it tries to connect to the Internet. How should I stop this?

Subarno Bhattacharya, Via e-mail

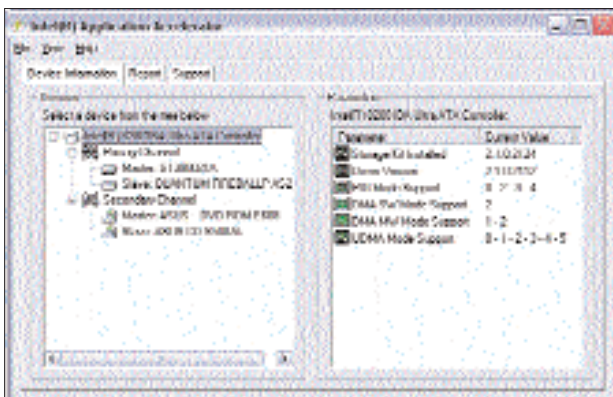
A Subarno, it seems that your PC has been affected by Spyware dialler programs that try to connect to the Internet without permission. These programs install themselves on your computer without your knowledge if you have visited certain sites. The dialler programs can be removed by using anti-spyware software such as LavaSoft Ad-Aware Personal Edition from www.lavasoft.com and Microsoft AntiSpyware from www.microsoft.com. After installing one of these programs, you have to update the definition files and then scan your PC for Adware and Spyware to remove them. You could also use Spyware Blaster or Spybot S&D given with the August 2005 CD of Digit.

Disappearing DMA

Q I have P 4 (2.4 GHz) processor, Intel 845GVSR motherboard and 256MB (DDR) RAM. My problem is that the DMA disappeared when I installed the Intel Application Accelerator in Windows 98. What is the reason?

Ranjit Kumar, Via e-mail

A When you install the Intel Application Accelerator, it takes over the control of the DMA transfer rates of IDE devices. Hence, you are not able to see the DMA settings. You can still access these through the Application Accelerator utility where you can decide to limit the transfer rate of a particular device.



Intel Application Accelerator

Do I Need An AGP Card?

Q I have a PC with the following configuration: Intel Pentium 4 3.0 GHz, 865G chipset, 256MB, 400Mhz RAM (64 MB on-board shared memory), 80 GB HD, 1MB Cache and 800 MHz FSB.

This is a Zenith PC and I opted for 865G chipset rather than 915G since the vendor told me that the AGP graphics card cost almost a third of PCIe cards. I have DirectX 9.0c installed. Max Payne 2 runs fantastically on the PC but my other game, "True Crime: Streets Of LA" that requires less resources than Max Payne 2 gives a fatal error saying "No capable 3D hardware found on your system. This game requires direct 3D compatible hardware that either supports either T&L or vertex and pixel shaders version 1.1 or higher". Also, the demo of Splinter Cell Chaos Theory 3 gives an error saying: "<?int?splintercell3.General.DirectX shader model 1.1 is required?>". Now will this problem be eliminated by adding an AGP card?

Parimal Rajkuntwar, Via e-mail

A The games that are giving you the errors require full DirectX 8.0 compliant graphics card. The on-board graphics of your motherboard is not compliant with this requirement. These games also require hardware transform and lighting, which the on-board graphics lacks. You will require a DirectX 8.0 compliant card, which means at least an NVidia GeForce 3 or an ATi Radeon 8500 to be able to play these games. Since these cards are no longer available, you can opt for any of the GeForce FX series cards, such as the FX 5600 which are available at a reasonable price.

Standalone DVD As Drive

Q I have Pentium IV, 1.8 GHz, 256 DDR RAM, Mercury Main board. I wanted to know if I could use my DVD player as a DVD drive.

Ujjawal Goel, Via e-mail

A If you are referring to a standalone DVD player, the answer is No, you cannot use it as a DVD drive for your computer.

TV Tuner Card Concerns

Q I have a Pentium 4 3.0 GHz (that supports Hyper-Threading technology), Intel D865 GBF motherboard, 512MB of KINGSTON DDR memory and a 40 GB Seagate hard disk running Windows XP Professional SP2. I have disabled on-board sound and installed a Philips PSC705 5.1 surround sound card. I have also installed Pixelview Play TV Pro Ultra TV Tuner Card version 3.3. After installing the TV Tuner Card, I noticed that there is some disturbance in sound quality (popping and crackling) when playing songs and games. I disabled Conexant 2388x video capture driver from the sound, video and game controllers. After disabling it, the sound is clear. But to watch TV, I need to enable it again. Doing this repeatedly is getting to be a chore Please tell me how can I get a clear sound without disabling the driver of TV tuner card?

Sugat Tuladhar, Kathmandu (Nepal)